

Alex Alvord

Advisory Solutions Architect, Hybrid Multicloud · AI infrastructure & agentic systems

Duvall, Washington · Pacific Northwest, remote-first

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PROFILE

I put AI systems into real infrastructure and explain them to the people who have to run and pay for them. Twenty years on both sides of the table: seven as a finance and operations controller, thirteen designing, selling and running cloud, OpenStack and bare metal, the three hyperscalers, and since 2019 Nutanix hybrid multicloud, where I joined NC2 as one of about fifteen people and watched it grow to 250. Since 2025 I have been hands-on with production agentic systems: a multi-agent operations stack with harnesses, tool policy, memory and local inference that I run every day from my home lab and publish as Cloud Lab Works, on my own time and equipment. Every design I do starts with what it costs to operate, GPUs included.

SELECTED WORK

Agentic operations stack: Cloud Lab Works

2025 – present

github.com/issaquahd · Invisible Wires — Agentic Cloud

- Multi-agent system on OpenClaw with a principal agent, sub-agents and a family agent; three model lanes routed by task (hosted frontier models by subscription and API, local Qwen via Ollama), each kind of work pinned to a lane with no silent fallback.
- File-backed identity and memory in git; semantic memory with local embeddings (nomic-embed-text) and no egress; prompt-injection defenses (untrusted-content markers, paired senders, memory-less inbound agents); secrets that never enter model context (egress-proxy sentinels, vault-only credentials, CDP-side injection).
- Agents that run infrastructure: Cloudflare Workers + Zero Trust across three domains deployed by agent, scheduled sentinels for site health, a post-to-email pipeline, and Infrastructure as Music (lab state rendered as a live instrument).
- Governance as code: a constitution with gated vs. ungated action classes, prompt-budget limits with soft ceilings, a control ledger, and a persona prompt budget enforced at build time.

NC2 on AWS, as code

2026

Nutanix Notes · v4 APIs, OpenTofu, Flow Virtual Networking

- End-to-end walkthrough from the NC2 console to the first VM with every block verified against the provider; the pattern used in customer PoCs and lab sessions.

WHY THESE COMPANIES

Every job I took was a bet on where infrastructure was going. Here is why I made each one.

RightScale (2013): early to cloud when "cloud" still meant one vendor. RightScale's thesis was that orchestrating resources through APIs would matter more than owning them: multi-cloud management, ServerTemplates, automation across AWS, Azure, SoftLayer, Rackspace and Google Compute Engine years before "multicloud" was a category. Its co-founder and CTO, Thorsten von Eicken, had been a Cornell computer-science professor who co-authored the U-Net work with Werner Vogels, later Amazon's CTO. I worked the AWS alliance from inside that company, and it was a front-row seat to the API-first, orchestrate-don't-own model everything since has been built on.

Smartsheet (2014): SaaS at enterprise scale before it was assumed: rollouts from 2,000 to 200,000 seats, API partners as the growth channel, SSO and governance as the buying criteria. The playbook for how software actually lands in a large company.

Internap / INAP (2015 – 2018): a monster in networking: a global backbone with route-optimized transit and high-density data centers, plus OpenStack, bare-metal cloud and colocation on top. That is where Layer 2–7, peering, latency and the physical substrate under "the cloud" became first-hand for me. Most cloud architects never touch it.

Rubrik (2018 – 2019): the data layer reinvented as a cloud-native, API-first platform: backup, recovery, replication and search as one distributed system with an open API, at the moment ransomware made data management a board-level problem. As the Systems Engineer for the Pacific Northwest channel I spent my days teaching the ecosystem how orchestration and Open APIs change operations.

Nutanix (2019 –): the hybrid multicloud bet made real: the same platform on-prem and in AWS, Azure and Google Cloud. I joined NC2 when it was about fifteen people and it is 250 now. The v4 APIs, Flow Virtual Networking and infrastructure-as-code are the chapter I am in; AI infrastructure next to the data (GPUs, storage, and the cost model) is the next one.

EXPERIENCE

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SKILLS

AGENTIC & AI INFRASTRUCTURE

- Multi-agent orchestration
- Agent harnesses & tool policy
- LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI-compatible)
- Model routing · hosted + local
- MCP tool integration
- Memory engines · embeddings · RAG
- Local inference (Ollama)
- Prompt-injection defense
- Sandboxed execution
- Evals & verification gates
- GPU/AI substrate sizing
- Inference cost modelling

HYBRID MULTICLOUD

- Nutanix NC2 · AWS · Azure · GCP
- Prism Central · v4 APIs
- Flow Virtual Networking · OpenStack
- VMware · KVM · Hyper-V · AHV
- Datacenter divestment · L2 stretch
- DR · Multicloud Snapshot

CLOUD NATIVE & IAC

- OpenTofu / Terraform · Ansible
- Kubernetes · Containers · GitOps
- Cloudflare Workers · Zero Trust
- Proxmox · CI/CD

BUSINESS

- FinOps · TCO / ROI · Cloud economics
- PoC / PoV design
- Partner & channel enablement
- Insight Selling · Financial forecasting
- Public speaking · labs

HONORS

FY24 Americas Portfolio Solutions Architect of the Year, Nutanix

Solutions Architect of the Quarter: Q4 2022, Q2 2023, Q4 2024, Q1 2025, Q3 2026

Authority Magazine interview on digital transformation, Dec 2025

INAP President's Club 2015 – 2017

Seattle Nutanix User Group: founder, 2020

CERTIFICATIONS

Nutanix

2019 – present

Seattle, WA · Americas Solutions Architecture, Hybrid Multicloud

Advisory Solutions Architect, Hybrid Multicloud (2023 –) · Hybrid Multicloud SME (2021 – 2023) · Sr. Systems Engineer (2020 – 2021) · Systems Engineer (2019 – 2020)

- Subject-matter expert for Nutanix Cloud Clusters (NC2) on AWS, Azure and Google Cloud, from the incubation team to a 250-person organization; owns the NC2 on AWS lab sessions at Global Tech Summit since 2023 and presents on the XTour since 2022.
- Runs the field motion end to end: PoC/PoV, multi-phase migration journeys, FinOps and TCO/ROI, solution demos, and partner and channel enablement across the Americas.
- AI infrastructure engineering for customers moving models next to their data: GPU node sizing, storage and network substrate, and the cost model that decides on-prem vs. cloud for inference and fine-tuning.
- Built the "Commercial TCO/ROI light" that any AE/SE can run in front of a customer; trained partners and account teams on it; a core differentiator that shortened time to purchase.
- First Commercial SE hired in the Pacific Northwest; supported WA, OR, ID and AK, closed the largest Oregon Commercial and Alaska deals of the time, and onboarded every Commercial AE in the region. Mentored four Systems Engineers directly.
- Founder and champion sponsor of the Seattle Nutanix User Group (2020 –); founded the Anchorage NUG (2020 – 2022).

Cloud Lab Works LLC

2026 – present

Duvall, WA · Principal · working lab and open collaboration on projects

- A working lab and a place to collaborate live on projects (not a consultancy): agentic operations, AI infrastructure sizing (GPU, storage and network substrate), open-source repos, technical writing, speaking and mentoring. Own time, own equipment, public information only.
- Runs the lab as a product: M4 Pro inference host, Proxmox sandbox tier, Tailscale subnet routing, Cloudflare edge; everything with an owner, a health check and a place in git.
- Writes *Invisible Wires* — *Agentic Cloud* and *Nutanix Notes*; sixty-plus conference-years of field work since 2011, staff on site at re:Invent, Ignite and Google Cloud Next.

Rubrik

2018 – 2019

Seattle, WA · Systems Engineer, Pacific Northwest channel

- Technical lead for cloud data management across hybrid and multicloud, Open API integrations, SaaS (O365), orchestrated DR and ransomware analytics.
- Enabled the channel (VARs, LARs, SIs, consultancies) through instructor-led sessions, QBRs and the LMS; drove the ecosystem: ServiceNow/ITSM, Ansible, Chef, Puppet, SaltStack, containers, HashiCorp.
- 2018 quota attainment: 175% Q1, 210% Q2, 195% Q3, 220% Q4.

Internap (INAP)

2015 – 2018

Seattle, WA · Cloud Solutions Architect

- Owned technical feasibility and design for large hybrid solutions: OpenStack, bare-metal cloud, VMware, Hyper-V and KVM private cloud, colocation, managed hosting, Layer 2–7 networking and compliance.
- Migration strategy, interoperability, orchestration and API management across OpenStack, AWS, Azure and Google Cloud; Equinix Cloud Exchange hybrid designs.
- Trained partner SE communities at AWS, Azure, VMware, New Relic, NGINX, OpenStack, NetApp and Aerospike; ran the labs and wrote the whitepapers and case studies. President's Club 2015, 2016, 2017 (top 5% revenue attainment).

Smartsheet

2014

Bellevue, WA · Strategic Accounts (technical + sales)

- Enterprise-wide SaaS rollouts from beachhead to site license for organizations of 2,000 to 200,000 seats; co-selling with API partners; scope covered Open APIs, compliance, security, governance and SSO. Completed M3 Proactive Selling with its author.

RightScale

2013

Seattle, WA · Technical Account Manager

- Partner alliances with AWS, Azure, IBM SoftLayer, Rackspace and Google Compute Engine; ran the AWS west-coast joint enablement cadence: leads up 310%, close rate up 23%, sales cycle 19 days shorter.
- Multi-cloud PoCs on the RightScale platform: portability via orchestration and automation; a multi-cloud Open API Wi-Fi framework for what became South America's largest airline group.

Zones

2007 – 2013

Seattle, WA · Enterprise Solutions Architect, Export Center

AWS Solutions Architect – Professional; Solutions Architect – Associate; Cloud Practitioner

Microsoft Azure Solutions Architect Expert; Azure Administrator; Azure Fundamentals

Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect

Nutanix NCP – Multicloud Infrastructure; NCP – Multicloud Automation; NCP – SME; NCSE I & II

Kubernetes Administrator

Also IBM Certified Cloud Computing Advisor; EMC Cloud Infrastructure & Services; Rackspace uCloud; Red Hat partner (platform, middleware, virtualization); VMware, Citrix, Cisco, Juniper, NetApp, Oracle sales and technical tracks; Sandler Training

COMMUNITY

OpenStack foundation member (2011); CNCF (2015); SNIA technical council (2025); Cloud Security Alliance CxO Trust WG; FinOps Foundation; FINOS; ONUG

Mentor: PLU Econ Mentoring Program (2016 –), National Society of Sales Engineers, Technology Access Foundation

Full list: cloudlabworks.dev/#volunteering

LANGUAGES

English · Mandarin Chinese (eight years of study; lived in China)

- Complex solutions for strategic and large enterprise accounts (cloud, HPC, networking, analytics) with project management through delivery. Top 1% in revenue and margin; employee of the quarter three times.
- Certified Zones to sell enterprise technologies it had not been authorized for (public cloud, JD Edwards); "Insight Selling" cut the net-new sales cycle to 36 days.

Earlier

2001 – 2007

The HN BBPIL LLC, Seattle: Controller, Finance & Operations (2001 – 2007) · Invisible Wires Inc., Seattle: Project Manager, Business Analytics (2005)

- Ran finance and operations reporting to the executive team: forecasting, asset management, cost control; redesigned operations for a 22% year-over-year margin gain and double-digit revenue growth; brokered the company's sale and led through the acquisition.
- Launched a SaaS analytics stack integrated with POS and CRM: real-time view of customer behaviour and variable cost, double-digit reduction in variable costs. The name lives on as the blog.

EDUCATION

Pacific Lutheran University

2001 – 2006

Bachelor of Business Administration, Information Technology Management · AACSB-accredited

University of Washington

2013 – 2014

Cloud Data Management & Analytics

Peking University, Beijing

2001

Mandarin Chinese

This is the living résumé; it changes as the work does. © Alex Alvord.